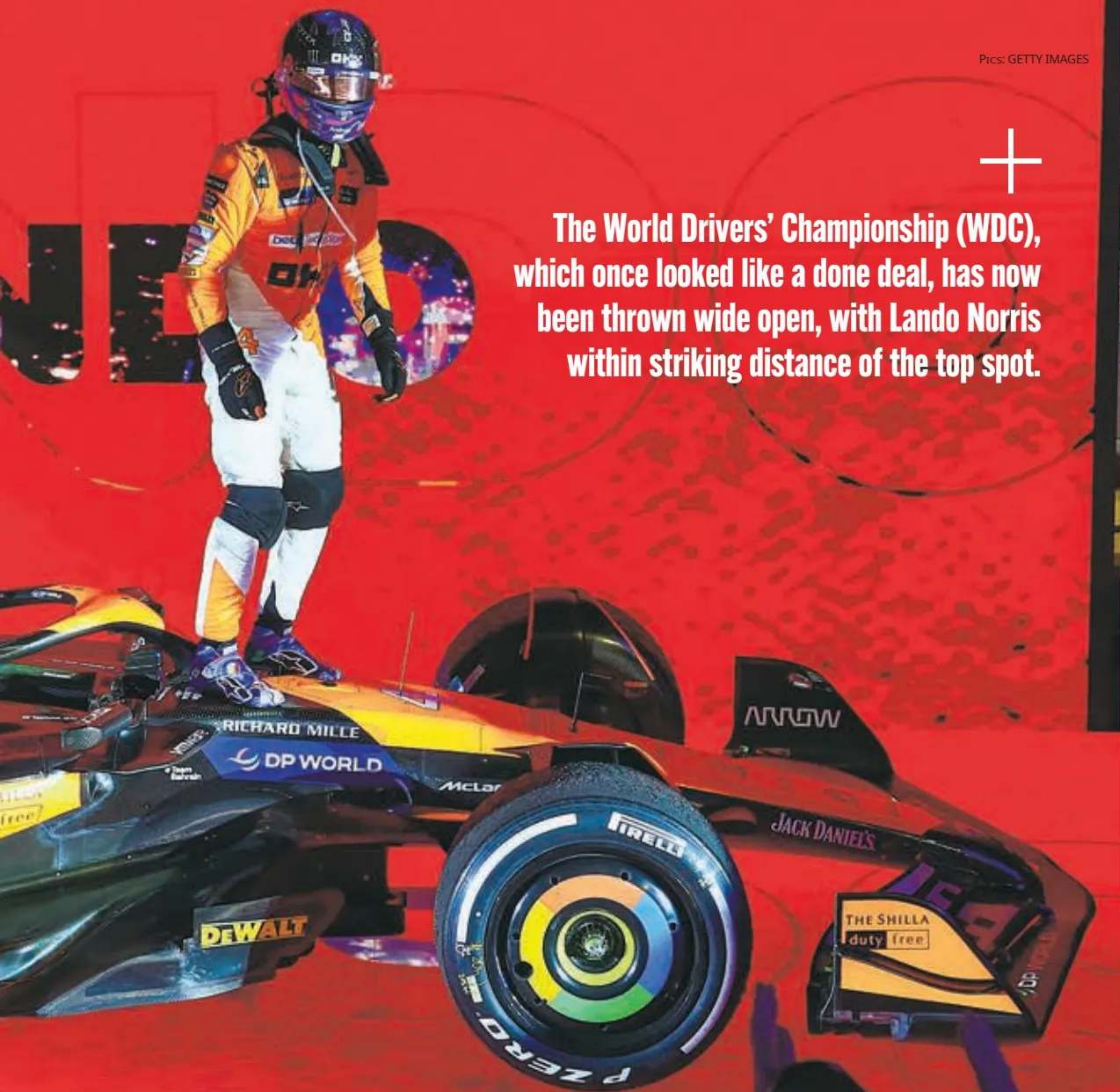




The World Drivers' Championship (WDC), which once looked like a done deal, has now been thrown wide open, with Lando Norris within striking distance of the top spot.



Marina Bay Circuit, increasing his lead over Verstappen's Red Bull until he was completely out of sight, and ultimately taking the win with a commanding 20-second advantage.

The World Drivers' Championship (WDC), which once looked like a done deal, has now been thrown wide open, with Norris within striking distance of the top spot. Although Verstappen's great start to the season was followed by some forgettable races, the cushion of his earlier points has helped him maintain a lead at the top.

But no one expected a serious challenger to the throne, or anyone remotely standing in the way of the Dutchman's fourth successive crown. While Verstappen (**right**) may have faced a peaking Lewis Hamilton and the occasional threat from Ferrari's Charles Leclerc in recent past, not many would have expected McLaren and Norris to be a threat this time. To put it in perspective, Norris, who had never won a race in his five previous F1 seasons, has won three this year. His teammate, Oscar Piastri, has also secured his first two

